

The Local Star

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FRONT PAGE

Native To Hybrid And Back Again

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

I was recently attending NativeScript Developer Day 2017 in New York City, which is Telerik's very own NativeScript conference.

This was a fantastic conference where I was not only a participant, but also a speaker at the event. At this event I had given a fresh presentation titled, Native to Hybrid and Back Again , where I had discussed my own personal experiences when it came to mobile application development.

I want to take the opportunity to summarize what I discussed during this event and share the slides that went with my presentation.

The post Native To Hybrid And Back Again appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

FEATURES

Rare Rides Icons: The Jeep Wagoneer, The First Luxury SUV Ever (Part VII)

Corey Lewis · *The Truth About Cars*

After their purchase of Jeep in 1970, American Motors began diversification of the newly acquired brand's product line. The company saw the potential in Jeep for a much broader offering of passenger utility vehicles: Utility wagons, recreational utility vehicles, and trucks. The former two would gradually converge together in nomenclature to be called SUVs, a term Jeep created in 1974 when it marketed the new Cherokee (an SJ Wagoneer derivative). Part of the product diversification was refinement of the Wagoneer platform and experimentation with luxury trims after the Super Wagoneer failed to see much success. In 1978 AMC launched a new luxurious Wagoneer trim, and this time it worked.

The utility wagon market was changing in the late Seventies, as consumers proved they were willing to pay more for wagons (and pickups) with equipment far beyond the basic rigs of the past. General Motors launched the hugely successful C/K Suburban in 1973, which remained in production through 1991 just like the Wagoneer. With a more user-friendly design, the Suburban also (finally) had four passenger doors.

And like the Wagoneer, GM would refine and trim and introduce luxuries to the Suburban (both Chevrolet and GMC used the same model name) through the years. By the late Seventies, the large utility wagon market was served only by GM and Jeep, as International cancelled its final Travelall in 1975. IH was unable to sustain its model offerings during the OPEC Crisis, when its engines were dated and notably less efficient than the competition.

The first sustained upmarket push for the Wagoneer was a 1978.5 trim addition, the Wagoneer Limited. Limited began as a step above the already plush Super Wagoneer of a few years prior. With power disc brakes all around, standard air conditioning, power locks, windows, and seats, and standard leather upholstery. It also had a leather-clad tilt wheel, cruise control, more plush carpeting than other models, radio with AM/FM and CB, a roof rack, and forged aluminum mag wheels with whitewalls. Limited models were identifiable via their much thicker exterior wood paneling.

Most every option of the regular and Custom Wagoneers was standard on the Limited. All Wagoneers used a two-barrel 360 (5.9L) V8 by this time, where the AMC I6 was relegated to the standard engine of the Cherokee. Optional even on the limited was the high-power four-barrel 401 (6.6L) AMC V8.

Luxury credentials for the Wagoneer Limited were proved via its application of such a heavy standard feature set, standard V8, and power everything. If that wasn't enough, there was the Wagoneer Limited's asking price. In 1978 it asked \$10,500 (\$54,900 adj.). For reference, in 1978 a Lincoln Continental topped out at \$10,165 (\$53,148 adj.), Cadillac

DeVille asked \$10,445 (\$54,612 adj.) and an Eldorado was \$11,920 (\$62,324 adj.).

Immediately an exclusive vehicle, the Wagoneer Limited boosted the model's overall sales. In 1979 there was a styling update, making the Limited trim a half-year offering in the Wagoneer's old style. The update put the "modern" front end on the Wagoneer, and added a vertical slat grille in chrome, doing away with the eggcrate permanently. Worth noting, the same front end treatment was given to all SJ models, including Cherokee and pickups.

The circular sealed beam lamps were changed for the first time, and became square. Their housings were square to match. The grille took up a larger portion of the front end, as the hood was pulled back slightly, and the power bulge at the terminus made a part of the grille rather than the hood. It created a blunt looking front end, and enhanced attention to the power bulge.

Returning for duty were amber indicator lenses above the bumper. Those vanished circa 1973 with an update to the grille that saw large circular indicators set into it. Just beneath them, a revised bumper debuted with vertical bumper guards and black trim rub strips.

The rear bumper was revised as well, and got more square, losing its curved inset detailing. Though the rear lamp design remained the same, the trim panel at either side of the license plate was edited, and became vertical square blocks to mimic the shape of the indicator lenses at the rear. The design previously wore a horizontal bar design to mimic the grille.

Interior updates also arrived with the 1979 refresh, and included more wood trim on the interior in various places like the dash and door panels. Notably upgraded were the door panels of upper trims, which received thicker padding and nicer materials, a lesser variant of what was found in the 1978.5 onward Limited. Arm rests were upgraded with additional trim, and a new door pull appeared in a luggage strap style under the window (like a luxury sedan).

Thicker carpets appeared at the lower door panel, and there were now several different textures of materials on the door, not just one. A greater portion of the door was upholstered on the inside, where in 1978 there was a much larger volume of painted metal visible to the occupants. In other places on the interior, a variety of new upholstery options were offered in plaid fabric, soft vinyl, and leather in the instance of the Limited.

The greater economy and subsequent changes to fuel prices caused the awakening of the American consumer to the importance of fuel economy at the close of the Seventies. That would force AMC to reconfigure its largest utility wagon. AMC would also create what was the first crossover SUV in 1980, though they didn't realize it at the time.

Shortly thereafter, AMC began its efforts to replace and subsequently terminate the dated SJ Wagoneer. Each and

The Mercury Bobcat - Why It's Not As Bad As It's Reputation

Tony's Fords and Mustangs | TTAC Creator · The Truth About Cars

The Mercury Bobcat. It was Mercury's first subcompact car sold in North America and yes, it was a rebadged Pinto but it gave Mercury an inexpensive model that had good gas mileage numbers.

It was launched right after the start of National Highway Traffic Safety Administrations investigation into rear end collision fires and all the bad press that had come with it. In today's video we will take a look at the Bobcat and see how it fared. We will discuss the rear end collision issues at the end of the video and why I think this may have been a better media story than an actual issue.

The TTAC Creators Series tells stories and amplifies creators from all corners of the car world, including culture, dealerships, collections, modified builds and more.

A transcript, created by AI and edited by a staffer, is below.

[Image: Tony's Fords and Mustangs/YouTube]

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Transcript:

The Mercury Bobcat was Mercury's first subcompact car sold in North America. While it was essentially a rebadged Pinto, it provided an inexpensive option with good fuel economy at a time when such a car was needed. It also arrived just as the National Highway Safety Administration began investigating rear-collision fires in the Pinto, which generated significant negative press. In this video, we'll look at the Bobcat and discuss the rear-end collision fires at the end.

The Bobcat was first introduced in Canada in 1974 as a two-door sedan, a three-door runabout, or a two-door station wagon. It was essentially a Pinto with a slightly different egg-crate grille and wider tail lamps. The standard engine was an 80-horsepower 2.0-liter inline four-cylinder, with an optional 89-horsepower 2.3-liter Lima inline four-cylinder producing 112 pound-feet of torque. A four-speed manual transmission was standard, with a three-speed Ford C3 automatic available as an option. Standard features included 5 mph impact bumpers front and rear, rack-and-pinion steering, front disc brakes, color-keyed carpeting, slotted Argent wheels with hubcaps, and a fold-down rear seat. Optional packages included the Sport Accent Group, the Deluxe Bumper Group, and the Villager Group for wagons, offering a mix of styling, luxury, and convenience features. Other options included air conditioning, a vinyl roof, sunroof, rear window defroster, anti-theft alarm, suspension and handling package, 13-inch steel-belted radial tires, and AM or AM/FM stereo. Canadian dealers delivered about 10,000 Bobcats for 1974, considered a solid start.

In 1975, the Bobcat was introduced to the U. S. market. The two-door sedan was dropped, leaving only the three-door coupe and station wagon. Mercury refreshed the front with a unique hood and grille featuring small parking lamps, and the tail lamps were widened. Seat covers were redesigned, the 2.0-liter engine was replaced by the 2.3-liter as standard, and a 93-horsepower 2.8-liter V6 became optional, producing 140 pound-feet of torque. New options included trim rings, slotted aluminum wheels, and power steering for V6 models. Road & Track noted that the Bobcat looked like a Pinto in a new suit, emphasizing style and luxury over ergonomics. Performance tests showed 0-60 mph in 15.4 seconds and a quarter-mile in 19.9 seconds at 67 mph.

Mercury updated the Bobcat in subsequent years. The 1976 model added the "MPG" designation and new options like tilt wheel, speed control, power door locks, and a full-length console. The 1977 model introduced electronic Durospark ignition, aluminum bumpers, high-back bucket seats, and an optional all-glass rear window. The 1978 model added new exterior and interior colors, an AM/FM cassette option, and wire wheel hubcaps. The 1979 Bobcat received a substantial refresh with a new hood, fenders, grille, rectangular headlamps, updated dashboard, seats, door panels, and new stripes for the Sports Accent Group. The 1980 model dropped the V6 option, leaving the 2.3-liter four-cylinder as the sole engine, with two-tone paint and Sports Accent Group options including a blacked-out hood, front air dam, and rear spoiler. 1980 was the Bobcat's final year, replaced by the front-wheel-drive Mercury Lynx in 1981. Over its seven-year run, Mercury dealers delivered 224,046 Bobcats in the U. S. and Canada, averaging around 32,000 units per year.

Regarding the safety controversy, both the Pinto and Bobcat were studied extensively in business ethics and legal classes due to their fuel tank design, which could be damaged in rear-end collisions, sometimes causing fires. The tank lacked reinforcement between it and the rear panel, meaning a collision could drive it into the differential, where protruding bolts could puncture it. Reports suggested Ford was aware of the risk early on but delayed action, resulting in lawsuits and criminal charges. Ford was acquitted of criminal charges but paid millions in settlements and legal fees. On June 8, 1978, just before the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration could issue a formal recall, Ford voluntarily recalled 1.5 million Pintos and Bobcats, installing polyethylene shields, extending filler tubes, and improving tank seals. Later analysis argued the Pinto was no more prone to fire than comparable subcompacts of the era, with fewer fatalities than initially reported.

The key takeaway is that once Ford became aware of the issue, it should have acted promptly instead of resisting recalls. Today, manufacturers are much quicker to address safety concerns, which is reflected in the volume of recalls we see.

Sending and Requesting Data from MongoDB in a Unity Game

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

Are you working on a game in Unity and finding yourself needing to make use of a database in the cloud? Storing your data locally works for a lot of games, but there are many gaming scenarios where you'd need to leverage an external database. Maybe you need to submit your high score for a leaderboard, or maybe you need to save your player stats and inventory so you can play on numerous devices. There are too many reasons to list as to why a remote database might make sense for your game.

If you've been keeping up with the content publishing on the MongoDB Developer Hub and our Twitch channel, you'll know that I'm working on a game development series with Adrienne Tacke . This series is centered around creating a 2D multiplayer game with Unity that uses MongoDB as part of the online com-

ponent. Up until now, we haven't actually had the game communicate with MongoDB.

In this tutorial, we're going to see how to make HTTP requests from a Unity game to a back end that communicates with MongoDB . The back end was already developed in a tutorial titled, Creating a User Profile Store for a Game With Node.js and MongoDB . We're now going to leverage it in our game.

The post Sending and Requesting Data from MongoDB in a Unity Game appeared first on MongoDB .

Working With Shared Providers In An Ionic 2 Mobile App

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

When developing an Ionic 2 application there are often scenarios where it probably isn't a good idea to include repetitive source code in multiple application pages. A common example of this would be when it comes to database interaction in an Ionic 2 application. Sure you could establish a connection to the database on every page and query it, but it would probably make more sense to use it like a shared provider.

We're going to see how to create a SQLite shared provider, often referred to as a shared service or sometimes a singleton class, in an Ionic 2 Android and iOS application using Angular.

The post Working With Shared Providers In An Ionic 2 Mobile App appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

IN BRIEF

Bethany Mavis, Triathlete Magazine: The pre-race favorites delivered in Oceanside with a late lead change on the run for Blummenfelt, while Knibb held off a fast-charging Solveig Løvseth after a blistering bike course record ride.

Read the full article at Kristian Blummenfelt and Taylor Knibb Smash Course Records at 2026 Ironman 70.3 Oceanside on Triathlete .

Nic Raboy, Nic Raboy (polyglot developer): It is always nice to have splash screens in your application. It is a great way to get your branding out, and show that your application is currently loading. No one likes to see a blank white screen for five seconds during launch.

Lucky for us, it is incredibly simple to add a splash screen to your Ionic project. Using Apache Cordova's Splashscreen plugin, we can add a splash to our application with just two lines in our config.xml file.

The post Add A Splash Screen To An Ionic Framework Project appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

Triathlete.com, Triathlete Magazine: Ready to have your best 70.3 finish yet? This plan is for you!

Read the full article at 70.3 Triathlon Training Plan for Working Professionals on Triathlete .

Nic Raboy, Nic Raboy (polyglot developer): Not too long ago I wrote about using the NativeScript fetch module for making HTTP requests in an Android and iOS mobile application. Personally I find that the fetch module is a bit awkward to use, so this time we're going to take a look at using the http module instead.

The great thing about the NativeScript http module is that it is pretty much the same as it is in the other languages.

The post Use The HTTP Module Instead Of Fetch In NativeScript appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

Nic Raboy, Nic Raboy (polyglot developer): I've recently been exploring other options when it comes to web frameworks. I come from a PHP ZendFramework background, but since having upgrading to ZendFramework 2, I've not been impressed.

Since then I've been exploring more of Node.js. However, like PHP, web programming often works best with a framework. This is why I've been exploring Node.js with Express as the framework.

The post Create A Simple Web Application With Express.js appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

Nic Raboy, Nic Raboy (polyglot developer): If you're looking for a way to build a web application that can be deployed to a cloud provider, you should consider using a cloud provider that offers a managed database service. This way you can avoid the complexity of managing a database on your own infrastructure.

Recall Alert: 2020-2026 Ford Explorer, Lincoln Aviator

TTAC Staff · The Truth About Cars

Today's recall involves a handful of 2020-2026 Ford Explorers and Lincoln Aviators.

Ford is recalling 561 examples of the 2020–2026 Explorer and Lincoln Aviator due to improperly secured seat belt anchor bolts in the second-row outer seats. Dealers will inspect the bolts and repair or replace them as needed at no cost. Owner notification letters are scheduled to be mailed on March 23, 2026, and affected VINs have been searchable on NHTSA's website since March 19.

Disclosure: This article was partially written by AI and edited by a human staffer.

[image: Ford]

Become a TTAC insider. Get the latest news, features, TTAC takes, and everything else that gets to the truth about cars first by subscribing to our newsletter .

Convert A Node.js RESTful API To Serverless With OpenWhisk

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

When it comes to serverless solutions, there are many options available. If you're a fan of the Microsoft cloud, you could create Azure Functions . If you've been keeping up, I wrote a tutorial called, Take a Node.js with Express API Serverless Using AWS Lambda , which used the Amazon Web Services cloud. Another solution is Apache OpenWhisk , a solution available on IBM's Bluemix cloud.

We're going to see how to convert the Node.js with Express application that I had written about in a previous article , and make it serverless with OpenWhisk.

The post Convert A Node.js RESTful API To Serverless With OpenWhisk appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

1985 Ford Ranger 4x4 5-Speed at No Reserve

bringatrailer · Bring a Trailer

This 1985 Ford Ranger 4x4 was purchased by the seller from the original owner in February 2026 after it had been parked in a garage for approximately a decade. Finished in Silver Metallic over Regatta Blue cloth and vinyl, the truck is powered by a 2.8-liter V6 linked with a five-speed manual transmission and a dual-range transfer case. Equipment includes a LEER bed top, 14" steel wheels, power steering, front disc brakes, and an Xtreme Sound cassette stereo. This Ranger is offered at no reserve with a clean Carfax report and a clean Ohio title in the seller's name.

The truck is finished in Silver Metallic (1E) with black bumpers and features a LEER bed top, a bug shield, swing-away side mirrors, and mud flaps. Spots of rust on the left side were reportedly repaired under previous ownership, approximately 25 years ago.

The 14" steel wheels are mounted with 235/75 Republic Trail Mark Radial APR tires up front and Cooper Discoverer S/T rubber out back. The truck is equipped with power steering and manually locking front hubs, and braking is provided by front discs and rear drums. The seller tells us that the brake booster and shock absorbers were replaced in preparation for the sale.

The bench seat is upholstered in Regatta Blue cloth and vinyl and is accompanied by a color-coordinated dashboard and door panels. Interior ap-

pointments include a vinyl floor liner, a cabin heater, an Xtreme Sound cassette stereo, and manual-crank windows. The dashboard pad is cracked, and rust is noted on the left floorboard by the drain plug.

Instrumentation consists of an 85-mph speedometer and gauges for fuel level, oil pressure, coolant temperature, and amperage. The five-digit odometer shows 48k miles.

The 2.8-liter V6 was serviced with an oil change and a replacement carburetor in preparation for the sale. There is a ticking noise from the engine, which the seller believes to be a sticking lifter.

Power is sent to the rear or all four wheels through a five-speed manual transmission and a dual-range transfer case. The seller says that the fuel tank and straps were replaced in preparation for the sale. There is some rust on the undercarriage, and a coating has been applied.

The Carfax report is free from accidents or other damage.

Implement A Barcode Scanner Using Ionic Framework

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

I recently found myself needing to scan barcodes in one of my apps. More specifically I needed to scan quick response (QR) codes. After doing some searching I found that ngCordova had an extension for the Apache Cordova plugin BarcodeScanner which has the ability to scan barcodes in the following formats:

QR Code

UPC E

UPC A

EAN 8

EAN 13

Code 128

Code 39

ITF

Pretty much all the formats anyone would ever need. The plugin itself makes use of the very popular ZXing library.

The post Implement A Barcode Scanner Using Ionic Framework appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

Add Music, Sounds, and Other Audio to a Phaser Game

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

If you're building a game, you're probably going to need audio such as sound effects and background music at some point in time. Without audio, the gameplay experience can feel quite boring, which no one wants their game to be labeled as.

I've recently written quite a few tutorials on the topic of game development with Phaser. We've seen everything from adding and animating sprites , to handling collisions between game objects .

In this tutorial, we're going to see how to add audio to our Phaser 3.x game in the form of sound effects triggered by collisions.

The post Add Music, Sounds, and Other Audio to a Phaser Game appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

Creating a Multiplayer Drawing Game with Phaser and MongoDB

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

When it comes to MongoDB, an often overlooked industry that it works amazingly well in is gaming. It works great in gaming because of its performance, but more importantly its ability to store whatever complex data the game throws at it.

Let's say you wanted to create a drawing game like Pictionary . I know what you're thinking: why would I ever want to create a Pictionary game with MongoDB integration? Well, what if you wanted to be able to play with friends remotely? In this scenario, you could store your brushstrokes in MongoDB and load those brushstrokes on your friend's device. These brushstrokes can be pretty much anything. They could be images, vector data, or something else entirely.

A drawing game is just one of many possible games that would pair well with MongoDB.

In this tutorial, we're going to create a drawing game using Phaser . The data will be stored and synced with MongoDB and be visible on everyone else's device whether that is desktop or mobile.

The post Creating a Multiplayer Drawing Game with Phaser and MongoDB appeared first on MongoDB .

Communicate With Websockets In A NativeScript Angular Application

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

I've been playing around with sockets and websockets recently. Not too long ago I wrote about creating a real-time chat application using Golang and Angular that made use of websockets. In that example we created a chat server using the Go programming language and a client facing web application using Angular. The communication between the two used websockets to keep things real-time.

What if we wanted to create a native mobile application for Android and iOS that communicated via websockets to our server or any other websocket server? Using NativeScript, it is very possible to create a mobile client that works with the Golang with Angular example as seen previously.

The post [Communicate With Websockets In A NativeScript Angular Application](#) appeared first on [The Polyglot Developer](#).

2009 Toyota Vellfire at No Reserve

bringatrailer · Bring a Trailer

This 2009 Toyota Vellfire is a Japanese-market van that was acquired by the selling dealer and imported to Canada in 2026. Finished in White Crystal Shine over black cloth, it is powered by a 2.4-liter inline-four mated to a CVT automatic transmission. Features include antilock disc brakes, 20" Loxarny Tarkus alloy wheels, an Admiration lower aero package, xenon headlights, dual sunroofs, dual sliding side doors, a rear spoiler, front bucket seats, second- and third-row benches, dual-zone automatic climate control, privacy curtains, a rearview camera, and a Bluetooth-capable Kenwood touch-screen infotainment system. This Vellfire has 108k kilometers (68k miles) and is offered at no reserve by the selling dealer with a British Columbia registration.

The van is finished in White Crystal Shine and features a color-matched Admiration lower aero package. Exterior details include yellow fog lights, xenon headlights, power-folding side mirrors, tinted vent shades, dual sunroofs, a rear spoiler, clear taillights, front and rear parking sensors, and dual sliding side doors, the left of which is power-operated.

Black-finished 20" Loxarny Tarkus alloy wheels are mounted with Kenda Kuavela SL tires. Antilock braking is handled by four-wheel discs.

The front bucket seats and split-folding second- and third-row benches are trimmed in black cloth.

Woodgrain trim accents the dashboard and door panels, and additional appointments include push-button ignition, dual-zone automatic climate control, ambient lighting, privacy curtains, a rearview camera, and a Kenwood touch-screen infotainment system with Bluetooth connectivity.

The leather- and wood-grain-trimmed steering wheel frames a central digital display, a 180-km/h speedometer, an 8k-rpm speedometer, and gauges for coolant temperature and fuel level. The digital odometer indicates 109k kilometers (68k Miles).

The 2.4-liter 2AZ-FE inline-four was factory rated at 168 horsepower and 165 lb-ft of torque.

Power is sent to the front wheels through a CVT automatic transmission.

The car is being sold on its British Columbia registration, which serves as the ownership document in British Columbia, Canada. The vehicle is not yet 25 years old, and it has not been federalized for the US market.

Create Paper Wallets For Stellar XLM Coins With Angular

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

Continuing down my adventure of learning about and investing in various cryptocurrencies, I thought I'd explore Stellar , which is what I understand to be, a competitor to Ripple . If you've been keeping up, you'll remember that I had written about creating a Ripple XRP paper wallet in a tutorial titled, Generate Cold Storage Paper Wallets for Ripple XRP Coins with Angular .

In this tutorial, we're going to see how to accomplish the same task of generating a cold storage paper wallet with Angular, but this time we'll be doing it for Stellar XLM coins.

The post Create Paper Wallets For Stellar XLM Coins With Angular appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

Earn Extra Money As A Programmer With A Developer Blog

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

If you've been a long time subscriber to The Polyglot Developer , you'll know that I use the blog as a way to document what I learn on a day to day basis. I'll never remember what I did six months ago unless I document the steps to reproduce it later.

I'd like to think that I'm a developer first and a blogger or technical writer second. However, did you know that I'm earning money from both sides of this technical spectrum? I'm earning money from my day job as well as the blog.

We're going see a few things that will get you started with earning money through a programming blog.

The post Earn Extra Money As A Programmer With A Developer Blog appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

10 cool interior spaces that stood out this week

Nathaniel Bahadursingh · Archinect News

In case you haven't checked out Archinect's Pinterest boards in a while, we have compiled ten recently pinned images from outstanding projects on various Archinect Firm and People profiles.

Today's top images (in no particular order) are from the board Interiors .

Tip: Use the handy FOLLOW feature to easily keep up-to-date with all your favorite Archinect profiles.

↑ House in Avándaro in Valle de Bravo, Mexico, by ESTUDIO Ignacio Urquiza Ana Paula de Alba ; Photo: Rafael Gamo

↑ Quinta de Adorigo Winery in Tabuaço, Portugal, by Atelier Sergio Rebelo ; Photo: FG+SG - Fernando Guerra

↑ Hotel Indigo Nalati in Xinjiang, China, by Cheng Chung Design ; Photo: Wang Ting

↑ Progress Brand Showroom in Taizhou, China, by Lingjie AR. Design ; Photo: Yunmian Photography

↑ Ortiz House in São Paulo, Brazil, by Meireles + Pavan Arquitetura ; Photo: Fran Parente

↑ Wuhan Senbo Resort in Wuhan, China, by WJD Design-Endless Mind ; Photo: Hanmo Vision — Song Ye/Fupeng Wu

↑ Bend Hideaway in Bend, OR, by Feldman A...

QOTD: What Do The Exotics Know That We Don't?

Tim Healey · The Truth About Cars

The cost of gas is rising rapidly. So, too, is airfare, in part because of the cost of oil. Tariffs have hit certain parts of the economy hard. People are complaining about the cost of living – and the cost of new cars. I hear talk from the experts about a “K-shaped” economy.

Yet Rolls-Royce and Maybach are putting out high-end new products.

Rolls has a new coach-build collection planned, while Maybach is working on a minivan . Seems like an odd time to make a product gamble.

On the other hand, the top 1 percent of the top 1 percent are probably so deep-pocketed that they're more-or-less immune to the economy. I doubt Jeff Bezos is reducing his mega-yacht order this year.

It's also almost NFL Draft time – there will be some newly minted millionaires next month.

So, which is it? Do the exotic brands see something that's cause for optimism? Or is it simply that these brands cater to customers who don't feel any economic pain, no matter how bad it is for the rest of schmucks?

Sound off below.

[Image: Rolls-Royce]

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about cars first by subscribing to our newsletter .

Connect To Multiple Wireless Networks With A Raspberry Pi

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

So I recently picked up some more Raspberry Pi 3 units. You're probably thinking I'm building my own T1000 (Terminator reference) with these things. No, actually I got these units for work to play around with some IoT projects around the office at Couchbase . I have a few offices that I visit at Couchbase which brought up my need to have multiple possible wireless networks to connect to as I travel. These are headless units so I'm not connecting to them with a mouse and keyboard.

Now one would imagine that I can just add a bunch of networks to a configuration file in Linux, but that wasn't the case. There are special configurations that must be done to allow the Raspberry Pi to automatically connect to different wireless networks as they become available.

We're going to see how to add multiple WiFi network SSIDs to a Raspberry Pi operating with Raspbian so it can automatically connect as they become in range.

The post [Connect To Multiple Wireless Networks With A Raspberry Pi](#) appeared first on [The Polyglot Developer](#) .

Configuring Visual Studio Code for Arduino Development

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

I've been playing around with an Arduino Uno recently, something new to me since I've always only used Raspberry Pi hardware. Many Arduino devices, or at least the Uno like I have are inexpensive and a lot of fun to play around with. However, the development experience out of the box isn't exactly what I was familiar with or happy about. To develop and push code to an Arduino you need to use the Arduino Desktop IDE. If you're like me, you're a one IDE type of developer, so having to work in a different environment is a little less than ideal.

It doesn't have to be that way when developing with Arduino though.

In this tutorial I'm going to walk you through configuring Visual Studio Code for Arduino development. You'll be able to write code, deploy to hardware, and monitor the output.

The post [Configuring Visual Studio Code for Arduino Development](#) appeared first on [The Polyglot Developer](#) .

Manage Files In Android And iOS Using Ionic Framework

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

TPDP Episode #1: The Requirements for Developing Mobile Applications

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

This is officially the first episode in The Polyglot Developer Podcast! I've spent a long time thinking about creating a podcast, but now I can officially say that I've followed through with it. Episode #1: The Requirements for Developing Mobile Applications is an episode that I've broken into several parts because I feel there are different kinds of requirements.

What do you need in a mobile application?

What do you need to build a mobile application?

What do you need to do to drive success in a mobile application?

Those three topics should be considered by everyone looking to develop their first mobile application.

The post [TPDP Episode #1: The Requirements for Developing Mobile Applications](#) appeared first on [The Polyglot Developer](#) .

Use Visually Appealing Fancy Alerts In A NativeScript Angular Application

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

In pretty much every mobile application that I've ever made, I've had a need to use some form of alert dialog. The problem with this is that standard alert dialogs are boring and can actually make your application less attractive. This is where Fancy Alerts come in.

In NativeScript , there is a plugin called Fancy Alerts that can display visually appealing alerts with nice animations. These alerts have smooth color schemes and can make your application that much more important. We're going to see how to include such alerts in our NativeScript Angular application.

The post [Use Visually Appealing Fancy Alerts In A NativeScript Angular Application](#) appeared first on [The Polyglot Developer](#) .

Capturing Hacker News Mentions with Node.js and MongoDB

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

You may one day find yourself needing to make an Ionic Framework Android and iOS app that downloads media or in-app purchase content from a remote web server to the users device. Maybe you created an audio app that plays music from the cloud and you decided to cache upcoming songs in your playlist like Google Music does. This will involve downloading the media files to your device in the background so it is ready to go.

Lucky for us, Apache Cordova has a set of File APIs that we can use in our Ionic project for exactly this.

The post [Manage Files In Android And iOS Using Ionic Framework](#) appeared first on [The Polyglot Developer](#) .

Track The Device Geolocation In A NativeScript Angular Mobile Application

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

I get a particular set of questions quite a bit on my blog and other social media outlets. One of these questions includes how to use geolocation features such as GPS tracking within a NativeScript mobile application for iOS and Android. Many people want to be able to gather location information and in many cases use this information for mapping.

So what does it take to make use of the device GPS hardware for location tracking?

We're going to see how to create a mobile application for Android and iOS using NativeScript and Angular that makes use of geolocation in a few different ways.

The post [Track The Device Geolocation In A NativeScript Angular Mobile Application](#) appeared first on [The Polyglot Developer](#) .

QOTD: What Other Brand Showcase Events Should There Be?

Tim Healey · The Truth About Cars

If you're in the technology space, you've probably stumbled upon Hacker News at some point or another. Maybe you're interested in knowing what's popular this week for technology or maybe you have something to share. It's a platform for information.

The problem is that you're going to find too much information on Hacker News without a particularly easy way to filter through it to find the topics that you're interested in. Let's say, for example, you want to know information about Bitcoin as soon as it is shared. How would you do that on the Hacker News website?

In this tutorial, we're going to learn how to parse through Hacker News data as it is created, filtering for only the topics that we're interested in. We're going to do a sentiment analysis on the potential matches to rank them, and then we're going to store this information in MongoDB so we can run reports from it. We're going to do it all with Node.js and some simple pipelines.

The post [Capturing Hacker News Mentions with Node.js and MongoDB](#) appeared first on [MongoDB](#) .

Three Simple Ways To Get Online With A Raspberry Pi Zero IoT Device

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

As you know from the guides that I put out, I'm a Raspberry Pi collector. I collect the full size units as well as the Pi Zero units. In a previous post I explained how to emulate ethernet over a USB as a way to connect to a Pi Zero that is not using WiFi or ethernet. However, what happens when you decide you're at a point where you'd like to bring your Pi Zero online?

I'm going to show you three quick, easy, and cheap ways to get WiFi internet on your Raspberry Pi Zero IoT device, none of which will require any soldering or advanced hardware knowledge.

The post [Three Simple Ways To Get Online With A Raspberry Pi Zero IoT Device](#) appeared first on [The Polyglot Developer](#) .

Alias URLs In Hugo Websites Using RewriteRule For Htaccess

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

It's just about time for the annual Easter Jeep Safari in Moab.

Other OEMs have similar showcase events like this, whether it's Mini Takes The States or something like that. What brand should create this kind of event?

You can be serious or tonque-in-cheek, just follow the rules of the comments.

With that, you know what to do. Sound off below.

[Image: Jeep]

Become a TTAC insider. Get the latest news, features, TTAC takes, and everything else that gets to the truth about cars first by subscribing to our newsletter .

As you may remember, I recently released The Polyglot Developer 2.0 which was a migration from WordPress to Hugo. Because my WordPress permalinks matched a similar format to Hugo I didn't have to make too many changes. However, there was an issue with the category and tag taxonomies. In Hugo these were recommended to be plural, while in WordPress they were singular.

I'm currently using Apache for hosting The Polyglot Developer so I had to figure out how to redirect the previous WordPress traffic to prevent bad links which would hurt the search engine optimization (SEO) of my blog. We're going to see how I made such redirects happen.

The post [Alias URLs In Hugo Websites Using RewriteRule For Htaccess](#) appeared first on [The Polyglot Developer](#) .

Jeep Unveils 2026 Easter Safari Vehicles

Tim Healey · *The Truth About Cars*

Every year, Jeep heads to Moab to showcase some concepts. This year marks the 60th year the brand has done so.

Jeep has plenty to show for those Jeep fans who will invade the small town starting Sunday – the event carries through until April 5. That's Easter Sunday, hence the name.

This year's concepts include the Wrangler Anvil 715, which is a Wrangler modified for serious overlanding without adding "unnecessary" bulk. Another Wrangler concept is the Wrangler Buzzcut, which is a two-seater with "sporty" design and a quite obvious snorkel. The draw here is extra storage for more time spend in the backcountry.

The Grand Wagoneer Commander is a beefed-up Wagoneer that is meant to blend it in – at least in terms of body work. But the bigger, off-road-ready meats at each corner and the lighting rig on top give away the game. This beast is also meant to tow an off-road rig from one site to another.

The Wrangler Laredo concept simplifies the vehicle, using a Willys base. The Jeep XJ Pioneer is a lifted (two inches) 1984 Cherokee with a disconnecting sway bar, fender flares, rock rails, and 33-inch meats on 17-inch rims.

Finally, we come to the Jeep Gladiator Red Rock, which has a laundry list of items from Jeep Performance Parts, such as a steel front bumper.

While most of these concepts are showcase aftermarket parts, including those available from JPP, the Laredo suggests where Jeep may take that trim on the Wrangler next. We'd also note that both the Wrangler and Gladiator are getting a bit long in the tooth – some of what Jeep showcases here could make it onto the next generation of either model. To be clear, that's speculation on my part, and not reporting, but it wouldn't be surprising.

Jeep will be showcasing these vehicles to Easter Jeep Safari attendees in downtown Moab.

[Images: Jeep]

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Install A Better Custom ROM On The Amazon Kindle Fire

Nic Raboy · *Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)*

As some of you may know, I travel a lot. I am always on a plane without internet and not much to do. Up until now I've been using my iPad for watching the few movies I purchased from Google Play because Google Play lets you watch offline. The problem with this is my iPad doesn't have a lot of storage space and can't keep me entertained on a six or more hour flight. I heard Amazon Prime members can download movies for free and I saw that Amazon Kindle Fire tablets were only \$40.00 with an expandable SD card slot.

I purchased one of these \$40.00 tablets and a large micro SD card with the intention of downloading a bunch of movies as part of my Prime subscription. The problem is that my Prime subscription was part of a household account, which has fine print that says I can only stream, not download. This rendered the Kindle Fire tablet rather useless to me.

This lead me down the path of wanting to root the tablet and install a custom ROM to it. These are the things I did to turn my \$40.00 disappointing Kindle Fire tablet into something comparable to the \$200.00 tablets in circulation.

The post [Install A Better Custom ROM On The Amazon Kindle Fire](#) appeared first on [The Polyglot Developer](#) .

Build An Alexa Skill With Golang And AWS Lambda

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

It has been a few years since I last worked on and published an application, otherwise known as a Skill, for Alexa powered voice assistants. My last Skill titled, BART Control , was built out of necessity because of my commuting on the Bay Area Rapid Transit system. While I didn't open source it, I had created the Skill with Node.js and a publicly available BART web service. Since then I had written a tutorial titled, Create an Amazon Alexa Skill Using Node.js and AWS Lambda , which also focused on Node.js.

I'm a huge fan of Golang and was pleased to see that AWS Lambda recently started to officially support it. AWS Lambda isn't a requirement to creating Alexa Skills, but it is a huge convenience. To make things even better, Amazon recently sent me an invitation to take part in their developer offer to receive an Amazon Echo Show for publishing another Skill. The offer and Golang inspired me to develop another Skill and this time I wanted to share my process.

The post Build An Alexa Skill With Golang And AWS Lambda appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

Monitor MySQL And Auto Recover From A Crash

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

Since starting this blog in July of 2014, I have had an unexpected amount of growth. So much, that a lot of strain has been placed on my virtual private server (VPS).

A common issue that has plagued me and many other WordPress users is the awful MySQL crash due to exhausted resources. This is because the server has run out of resources due to traffic spikes or other anomalies. The worst part for me is that MySQL tends to crash while I'm sleeping, putting my blog out of commission for up to six hours at a time. This is not good when you're trying to be a reliable source of information on the internet.

Luckily, I've developed a script that will elegantly resolve these related problems.

The post Monitor MySQL And Auto Recover From A Crash appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

Tour Of Heroes As A NativeScript With Angular Android And iOS Application

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

When it comes to learning Angular, the go-to example is the Tour of Heroes tutorial that is found in the official Angular documentation. This is a great tutorial because it covers a lot of topics, however, it is a web application tutorial. What if we wanted to build a mobile application from it, or more specifically, a native mobile application with Android and iOS support?

We're going to see how to build a Tour of Heroes inspired iOS and Android mobile application using Angular and NativeScript .

The post Tour Of Heroes As A NativeScript With Angular Android And iOS Application appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

Using Couchbase With Docker And Deploying A Containerized NoSQL Cluster

Nic Raboy · Nic Raboy (polyglot developer)

You can do a lot of cool things with Docker , for example containerizing web applications, processes, and a bunch of other things. What happens when you want to deploy your database as a container, or more specifically, your distributed database as containers? Most NoSQL databases are distributed, meaning they can be easily clustered with data replication and a bunch of other awesome features. How do you provision each node or configure the cluster?

We're going to see how to create a custom Docker image for the popular document-oriented NoSQL database, Couchbase , and cluster a few containers together to make one awesome NoSQL cluster.

The post Using Couchbase With Docker And Deploying A Containerized NoSQL Cluster appeared first on The Polyglot Developer .

) above a standard Custom trim, the X-Code was a single-year Wagoneer.

Corey Lewis

The Local Star

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